
Dr Smith Mehta

138, Grevingaheerd, Beijum, Groningen,
Netherlands, 9737SR

s.n.mehta@rug.nl

09.05.1991

Nationality: German

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/smithmehta>

<https://www.imdb.com/name/nm14310551/>

SKILLS

- Interviews, Scientific Writing, Teaching, Curriculum development, Project Management, Content Strategy
- Languages: German (C1), Dutch (B2), English (C2), Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati
- Tools: NVivo, WordPress, MS Office

CURRENT POSITION

Assistant Professor | Rijksuniversiteit Groningen (University of Groningen)

Feb 2023 onwards

- Curriculum developer and coordinator (Start-up Lab, Media Spaces and Practices, Audio-Visual Cultures Research Seminar (2023-24), Digital Ethnography)
- Faculty-wide Lecturer (Stories we live by, Humane AI and the Digital Society)
- Accreditation Committee member for Lecturers (2024-25)
- Admissions Team (2025-)
- Lecturer in Media Studies topics
- MA and BA Theses Supervisor

ACADEMIC TRAINING

Doctoral media researcher | Digital Media Research Center, Queensland University Of Technology, Australia

July 2017 - March 2021

- Conducted a dissertation on the digital transformation of the Indian screen industries
- Conducted and analyzed 90+ interviews with media practitioners
- Communicated insights to different audiences in 5+ empirical research papers and 10 presentations at scientific conferences.
- Co-developed curriculum tutored and graded media-specific courses (e.g., Managing media and entertainment, Understanding audiences) for 100+ students

Post Graduate Diploma in Media Laws (A Grade) | National Academy of Legal Studies and Academic Research (Distance Diploma)

August 2013- August 2014

- Key topics: Media laws, Advertising laws, Public policy

Masters in Mass media and Communications (3.02 GPA) | Symbiosis Institute of Mass Media and Communications, Pune, India

July 2011- July 2013

Specialization: Journalism

Bachelor of Commerce (52%) | R.A. Podar College of Commerce and Economics

June 2006 - June 2011

SCIENTIFIC OUTPUT

- Mehta, S. (forthcoming). *Behind the screens: Indian Talent Agents and The Making of Global Media*, Manchester University Press.
- Simon, G., Poell, T., Nieborg, D., Mehta, S., & Caminhas, L. (in press). A perspective from Nollywood: Examining how GenAI is integrated in the Nigerian film industry. *AI & Society*.
- Mehta, S. (in press). Platforms, Policy, and Power in Global South Audio-visual Industries. In *Media Studies Now*. In Wood, H. & Deshbandhu, A (eds.). Routledge, London
- Mehta, S. (2025). Navigating privilege and precarity: A reflexive inquiry into identity, academia, and Indian media industries. *European Journal of Cultural Studies*.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/13675494251361366>
- Bidav, T., and Mehta, S. (Dec 2025). *Global South Creator Cultures*, London: Routledge, Taylor and Francis Ltd.
- Sinha, P., & Mehta, S. (2025). Negotiating content: the interplay of politics, audience, and gender in Internet-based production cultures in India. *Communication, Culture & Critique*, tcaf002. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ccc/tcaf002>
- Mehta, S. N., & Amit-Danhi, E. R. (2024). The Road To Censorship: The Case of digital audiovisual Industries in India. *International Journal of Cultural Policy*, 1-17.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10286632.2024.2402257>
- Bidav, T., & Mehta, S. (2024). Peripheral Creator Cultures in India, Ireland, and Turkey. *Social Media + Society*, 10(1). <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051241234693>
- Mehta, S. (2023). The New Screen Ecology in India: Digital Transformation of Media. *London: The British Film Institute*. Retrieved November 2, 2023, from
<http://dx.doi.org/10.5040/9781839025693>
- Mehta, S. (2023). Where are the Women? Gendered Indian Digital Production Cultures Post #metoo. *Television & New Media*, 24(7), 770-790.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/15274764221135798>
- Mehta, S., & Cunningham, S. (2023). Digitalization and Informality in media industries: beyond the platform-portal divide? *Contemporary South Asia*, 31(2), 276-290.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/09584935.2023.2203899>
- Cunningham, S., Mehta, S., Lunardi G., & Healy, G. (2022). YouTube and the social media entertainment-television interface. In Johnson D., *From Networks to Netflix*. Routledge (2nd ed.)
<https://www.taylorfrancis.com/chapters/edit/10.4324/9781003099499-23/youtube-stuart-cunningham-smith-mehta-gabriela-lunardi-guy-healy>
- Mehta, S., & Kaye, D. B. V. (2021). Media Censorship: Obscuring Autocracy and Hindutva-ideology in Indian Governance. *Communication, Culture and Critique*.
<https://academic.oup.com/ccc/article-abstract/14/3/524/6307131>
- Mehta, S. (2021). Indian intermediaries in new media: Mainstreaming the margins. *Convergence*, 27(1), 229-246. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1354856519896167>
- Mehta, S. (2020). Television's role in Indian new screen ecology. *Media, Culture & Society*, 42(7-8), 1226-1242. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0163443719899804>
- Mehta, S. (2020). Localization, diversification and heterogeneity: Understanding the linguistic and cultural logics of Indian new media. *International Journal of Cultural Studies*, 23(1), 102-120. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1367877919880304>
- Mehta, S. (2019). Precarity and New Media: Through the Lens of Indian Creators. *International Journal of Communication*, 13, 20.
<https://ijoc.org/index.php/ijoc/article/view/12577>

- Mehta, S. (2019). The perils of being a “woman”: Acute problems within Indian media ecology. *Feminist Media Studies*, 19(7), 1056-1060.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14680777.2019.1667077>
- Mehta, S., & Kaye, D. B. V. (2019). Pushing the Next Level: Investigating Digital Content Creation in India. *Television & New Media*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1527476419861698>

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026
Co-Discussant, Round Table discussion on monograph *Global South Creator Cultures*
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9yZqq2P_cTo
Discussant, *Working with media stakeholders*, University of Groningen. ICOG.
- 2025
Presenter, *Behind the Screens: Indian Talent Agents and the Making of Global Media*, Social Sciences and Humanities Veni Committee, Utrecht.
Poell, T., Ong, J., Guimarães Corrêa, L., Raman, U., Mutsvairo, B., Baykurt, B., Mehta, S., Ye, Z., Nieborg, D., Simon, G., Caminhas, L., & Arriagada, A. (2025, October). *Mainstreaming decolonial perspectives in media and communication* [Panel proposal]. Association of Internet Researchers (AoIR) Conference 2025, São Paulo, Brazil. Contribution ID 700.
Bidav, T. & Mehta, S. (March) *Global South Creator Cultures*. Paper presented in the Global Southening Internet, Data and AI Studies Workshop, Oxford Internet Institute, Oxford, UK.
- 2024
Co presenter with Dr Priyam Sinha on *Negotiating Content: The Interplay of Politics, Audience, and Gender in Internet-Based Production Cultures in India*, British Association for South Asian Studies: King’s College London.
Co presenter with Dr Eedan Amit Danhi on ‘*The road to censorship: The case of Indian digital audiovisual industries*’ at the ECREA pre-conference 2024 Digital Content Creators, Platforms and Changing Cultural Institutions
- 2023
7 minute provocation on Analysing Gendered Production Cultures in India, at the European Communication Research and Education Association (ECREA) Methods in Cultural Production and Media Industries Research Conference, October, 2023.
Inaugural Panel Discussion on Contemporary Cultures of Production at International Conference on Media and Communication, 2023 in India with Prof. Aswin Punathambekar, Dr. Nalin Mehta, Dr Sreya Mitra, Prof Anil Zankar, and Mayank Shekhar, September, 2023.
Co-presenter with Dr Tugce Bidav on Peripheral Creator Cultures: Perspectives from India, Ireland and Turkey at ECREA Contested Visibilities Conference, Portugal.
Panel presentation with Rahul Mukherjee, Elliot Montpellier, Tupur Chatterjee, Sagorika Singha on *(In)formal Labor Practices of South Asian Platform Intermediaries* in Global Perspectives on Platforms, Labor & Social Reproduction Conference, Amsterdam
Panel with Elisabetta Costa, Nayana Prakash, and Ruth Nunez on Typology of Precarious Regional Indian Online Creators in in Global Perspectives on Platforms, Labor & Social Reproduction Conference, Amsterdam
Paper presentation, *Where are the Women? Gendered Indian digital production culture post #metoo*, ECREA, Aarhus.
- 2022

Abstract presentation on *Where are the Women? Gendered Indian digital production culture post #metoo*, Digital Transactions in Asia Conference at Nanyang Technological University, Singapore and IIT Delhi, New Delhi, and livestreamed via Zoom.

- 2020

Panel presentation in International Variations in the Dynamics of Streaming on *Are Amazon Prime and Netflix the 'new' Bollywood?* for the International Communication Association (ICA), Gold Coast.

Presentation on *Tightening the Grip: Shifting Governance of India's Online Entertainment Content Space*, at the ICA 2020 Digital South Asia Pre-conference.

- 2019

Selected with a scholarship for paper presentation, Television's role in the Indian new screen ecology at National Communication Association (NCA) Shenzhen Forum held in Shenzhen University

- 2018

Selected with a scholarship to participate in the 2018 NCA Doctoral Honors Seminar at Vanderbilt University, Nashville, US (2018)

Research article, accepted with a scholarship for Master class with Prof. Michael Curtin at the Lingnan University, Hong Kong (2018)

INVITED BOOK TALKS

- With discussants Prof Tejaswini Ganti, and Prof Rahul Mukherjee, Alvin Johnson/J.M. Kaplan Hall, NY - 4 October 2024.
- Manipal University, Bangalore - 22 February, 2024
- IIT Hyderabad- 26 February, 2024
- GITAM University, Hyderabad (**Also**, Curriculum review committee member) - 28 February, 2024
- Central University Hyderabad - 01 March, 2024
- KC College, Mumbai (**Keynote speaker**) - 07 March, 2024
- Savitribai Phule Pune University - 11 March, 2024
- Symbiosis Institute of Media and Communication, Pune - 13 March, 2024

KNOWLEDGE VALORIZATION

- Opinion editorial, Mehta, S. (2025, July 4). *Karnataka's Fake News Bill: Why is a Congress government bent on passing a new Rowlatt Act?* The Indian Express.
<https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/karnatakas-fake-news-bill-is-vague-da-ngerous-10105610/>
- Opinion editorial, *Managing Expectations: The Precarious Reality of Cultural Work in the Digital Age*. The London Story, 21 Mar. 2025.
<https://thelondonstory.org/2025/03/21/managing-expectations-the-precarious-reality-of-cultural-work-in-the-digital-age/>
- Opinion editorial, *How India's media control stifles freedom in the digital age*. 360info, 27 Feb., 2024.
<https://360info.org/how-indias-media-control-stifles-freedom-in-the-digital-age/>
- Quoted in a news article, *Hijacking The Influencers*, *Airmail*, 07 Dec., 2024.
<https://airmail.news/issues/2024-12-7/hijacking-the-influencers>
- News coverage on my research by an independent news organization, *Newslaundry*, 24 Oct, 2024.
<https://www.newslaundry.com/2024/10/24/ambiguous-communication-study-points-to-it-r-ules-chilling-impact-on-audiovisual-industry>

- Opinion editorial, How India's media control stifles freedom in the digital age, October 30, 2024. [360info.org](https://360info.org/how-indias-media-control-stifles-freedom-in-the-digital-age/).
<https://360info.org/how-indias-media-control-stifles-freedom-in-the-digital-age/>
- Quoted in a news article on Influencers : Scammers Target Middle East Influencers With Meta's Own Tools, *Bloomberg*, July 30, 2024.
<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2024-07-30/meta-copyright-tool-is-exploited-in-middle-east-by-extortionists?>
- Opinion editorial, The limits of censorship: Understanding the withdrawal of draft Broadcasting Bill, *Indian Express*, August 16, 2024.
<https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/limits-of-censorship-understanding-withdrawal-of-draft-broadcasting-bill-9517688/>
- Co-Panellist, Implications of the Broadcasting Services Bill, 2023. Organised by the Internet Freedom Foundation, 28 Nov 2023.
<https://www.linkedin.com/events/7133788641494990848/comments/>
- Opinion editorial, Regulating OTT: Draft Broadcasting Regulation Bill may be an attempt to control digital infrastructure, *Indian Express*, November 16, 2023.
<https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/ease-of-control-9028225/>
- Podcast on New Books Network, with Priyam Sinha on The New Screen Ecology in India, Oct 15, 2023. <https://newbooksnetwork.com/the-new-screen-ecology-in-india>
- Profile story on my research on gendered production cultures, *Mid-day*, Jan 08, 2023.
<https://www.mid-day.com/sunday-mid-day/article/no-ott-for-filmy-women-23264342>
- Podcast interview in Gujarati Language on International women's day, SBS Gujarati, Australia, March 08, 2023.
<https://www.sbs.com.au/language/gujarati/gu/podcast-episode/international-womens-day-female-actors-situation-in-films/z9zbnigs8>

GRANTS

- Collaborator, SSHRC Partnership Development Grant (75000 CAD), 2026, with lead PIs David Nieborg, Thomas Poell Hiromi Tanaka, Marco Monteiro, and Ruchi Jaggi.
- Leverhulme Small Research Grants 2025-26 - 9,983 Euros with Dr Tugce Bidav
- Maynooth University Social Sciences Institute's Small Grants Scheme 2022-3 - 4983 Euros with Dr. Tugce Bidav (lead PI)
- Center for Advanced Internet Studies Fellowship (2021-22) - 14,000 Euros
- Queensland University of Technology Postgraduate Research Award (2017-20) - 26,682 Euros

SELECTED TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- University of Groningen (2023 -)
 - Media Platforms and Industries 1 and 2 (BA 1)
 - Audiovisual Cultures Research Seminar (BA 2)
 - Start-up Lab (MA 1)
 - Media Entrepreneurship (BA 1)
 - Media Spaces and Practices (MA 1)
- Designed and delivered the Evolving Media Technologies Course over Zoom at the Symbiosis Institute of Media & Communication (SIMC PG), Pune. (Nov. 2021)
- Indian Institute of Digital Education Trainer: The Art of Pitching (March 2021-June 2021)
- QUT Sessional Academic Tutor (Feb - Nov 2019):

- o Managing Media and Entertainment (Feb - June 2019)
- o Entertainment Strategy (July - June 2019)
- o Global Media and Entertainment Industries (July - Nov 2019)
- Designed and delivered a two-day workshop on Qualitative Research to Post Graduate students of the Symbiosis Institute of Media & Communication (SIMC), Pune. (Aug 2018)
- Designed and delivered a 7-day workshop on Digital transformations of the society at the Ahmedabad University for first year media undergraduate program. (Dec 2016)

PROFESSIONAL ACCREDITATIONS AND MEMBERSHIP

- EU Expert in assessing EU funding applications : EX2025D1315878
- Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access Committee member, International Communication Association (2025-28)
- Young Arts Network Member, University of Groningen
- Co-convenor of Cultures of Media Production Group, University of Groningen
- Association of Internet Researchers
- European Communication Research and Education Association
- International Communication Association
- Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (UK and Australia) for teaching qualification
- Certified University Teaching Qualification in Higher Education (Netherlands)

REVIEWER

- Reviewed manuscripts of reputed peer-reviewed journals like Television and New Media, International Journal of Cultural Studies, International Journal of Communication and Convergence (<https://www.webofscience.com/wos/author/record/AAY-8425-2020>)

INDUSTRY AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

EU Commission Expert Evaluator : Skills and Talent Development in Media

May 2026

Youtube Kids topic expert

April 2024

Co-developer and speaker for "Diversity Matters: How Inclusion Boosts Audience Reach," a workshop by the Center for Scholars & Storytellers at UCLA, for YouTube Kids content creators in India, focusing on the business and societal benefits of diverse and inclusive media representation.

Freelance Media Consultant | Rushlake Media | Germany

Jan 2022 - April 2022

- Developed a movie-recommendation system to improve acquisition strategy
- Advised marketing and sales team on the strategic use of social media platforms

Research Fellow | Center for Advanced Internet Studies | Germany

October 2021 - March 2022

- Successfully won a 6-month fellowship to conduct a qualitative study on gender equity in pay parity, participation, and safety in Indian streaming services between 2014-2020.

Senior Research Associate | Mudra Institute of Communications Ahmedabad | India

July 2016 - June 2017

- Course management of Digital Communication Management (Masters Level)
- Developed 11-month Media and Entertainment Management course for media professionals
- Managed social media and assisted with travel-related queries for the International Communication Management Conference 2017

Producer | Voot (Viacom18 Digital Platform), Mumbai | India

October 2015 - June 2016

- Management of the web-series 'Badman' from pre-production to post-production
- Development of story-ideas, tracking of scripts, and web-series pitches to identify content and talent for the platform

Associate Producer | Viacom18 Motion Pictures, Mumbai | India

July 2013 - September 2014

- Conceptualized and executed the 'Cineshots' project to identify talent and acquire five short films for broadcast and digital distribution
- Part of the content team with more than 10 film credits (e.g., Margarita with a straw)
- Identified scripts, books and pitches to hire potential talent and commission content

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Creative team member of Viacom18 Media Pvt Ltd for 9 feature films and 1 webseries
- QUT SAGE Higher Degree Research Publication award (April 2021)
- Selected by UNESCO as the youngest Creative Specialist for the workshop on the Protection and promotion of diversity and cultural expressions in the Asia Pacific region in Seoul (June 2018)
- Awarded *Superstar* of the Quarter and *Rockstar* of the Quarter (2014) for successful execution of the studio's first short-film property 'Cineshots' at 50% of the allotted 150.000€ and for leading a seamless cross-functional communication with the Legal, IT, Marketing, and Production team

VOLUNTARY ACTIVITIES

Mentor (remote) | Bahujan Economists

August 2022 -

Mentoring media students from marginalized backgrounds for admission into PhD programmes

Volunteer | The Lighthouse Project India

September 2015 - March 2016

Mentored a 12-year-old student from a marginalized background to assist in social skill development